

Project 3

Course Code and Name: MSJ2201 Mass Communication

Project Name: Threatening Social Cohesion and Undermining Democracy

Project Type: Mask Making

Project Theme: Group Polarization

Semester of Submission: Summer 2023

Project Description:

This project was a creative mask-making assignment based on the theme "Group Polarization." Our group created a symbolic mask to show how political polarization can divide people, reduce social unity, and negatively affect democracy. We used different colors, cave art, spiral patterns, and dried plants to represent conflict, divided beliefs, and the harmful effects of polarization. The completed artwork was displayed at the CI Visual Art Exhibition at ULAB, where we explained the meaning of our work to visitors and received valuable feedback from faculty members and guests

Project Justification:

Group polarization is an important social issue because it increases conflict and reduces understanding between people with different opinions. This project encouraged us to think critically about how political and social divisions can affect peace, trust, and communication in society. Using visual art to express these ideas allowed us to present a complex topic in a creative and meaningful way while raising awareness among the audience.



REPORT ON MASK MAKING PROJECT

Course Name: Mass Communication

Course Code: MSJ2201

Section: 01

"Political Polarization: Threatening Social Cohesion and Undermining Democracy"

Submitted by

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"Political Polarization: Threatening Social Cohesion and Undermining Democracy"

Curriculum Integration (CI) Theme:

Every semester, the ULAB Media Studies and Journalism Department organizes CI, a program that encourages students to learn outside the classroom and present their creative ideas. The topic for this semester (Summer 2023) was Group polarization. The "Group Polarization" Curriculum Integration (CI) Theme aims to give students a thorough and comprehensive understanding of the psychological phenomena of group polarization. The tendency for groups to make more extreme decisions than their individual members' initial inclinations is known as group polarization. This theme explores group polarization's causes, effects, and potential mitigating actions. It includes findings from psychology, sociology, communication studies, and ethics. Mainly Students can develop an informed viewpoint on the dynamics of group decision-making and its implications for society by including group polarization in the curriculum. This subject gives them the tools they need to participate in critical debates, make more deliberate decisions, and advance productive discussion in a variety of group contexts.

Our Message:

Our subject line fits with the CI theme. We focused on political polarization's impact. Political polarization, which means the growing gap between groups with different beliefs, is a big worry in today's world. This happens when people have really strong opinions that push them apart and make it hard to talk calmly. This topic looks at how this kind of solid division can be bad for how a country is run. It can stop important decisions from happening, make people not trust the system, and let wrong information spread. Additionally, it can create violence in society. It also portrays how this can affect how well people get along because they mostly talk to others who think just like them.

Layout:

At first, we painted the whole canvas and the mask with the color of soil. That represents the earth. We used ancient cave fresco art on our canvas to portray the violence of the society. We just used

the character style of art. Represented the nebish nature of human beings. We used a spiral tattoo art on the left eye of the mask representing the polarized ideology and their influence on dividation. At last, we attached some dead plants on the top right. That represents the result of polarization. Overall presenting that polarization will make us live less.

Painting and Installation:

White, black, brown, and additional acrylic colors were used to paint the mask. First, we cover the entire canvas with plaster of Paris. Then we colored it with an extra white acrylic color then covered it with light brown. In the frame, we have given cave art through black color. As a craft, a dead plant is placed on top of the mask.

Exhibition:

We exhibited our masks at the CI visual art exhibition, which took place on January 4, 2020, at the ULAB permanent campus. Every mask on exhibit was different, but ours stood out due to its combination of colors. We were able to communicate with the audience about conditioning, which made the presentation successful. Everyone applauded the youngsters' effort and ability to grasp the theme. The event's Chief guest was. Most of the on-lookers were ULAB staff, faculty, students, and other personnel. There were also a couple of the pupils' relatives and friends. It would be preferable to exhibit at a prominent gallery rather than using the rooftop of a permanent campus as the venue. Bangladesh Shipakala Academy, for instance, would be a better site because more people would go there. However, having the exhibition on our own campus for the first time was truly remarkable. We were pleased to get the opportunity to see a different CI visual art display in a warm atmosphere.

Feedback:

During the exhibition, we conducted interviews with two ULAB faculty members and our chief guest who graciously shared their valuable insights. Our exhibition theme was closely tied to the interviewees. Our interviewees included Dr. Sarkar Barbaq Quarma (PhD), Syeda Sadia Mehjabin, and Rezwan Shahriar Sumit (Filmmaker). They all liked our artwork. They connected with the topic and the metaphorical presentations. They also liked our idea of using cave art.

Realization:

In the end, we understood that the message on our mask was clear and that group polarization is a huge problem in our society and culture. Our main focus was on the political polarization threat, which illustrated an increasing distance between groups with divergent ideologies and is a major

cause for concern in the modern world. This occurs when individuals have extremely strong ideas that drive them apart and make it difficult to communicate quietly. This subject examines how a country's governance may suffer from such clear-cut divisions. Important decisions may not be made, people may lose faith in the system, and inaccurate information may spread. Violence may also result from it in society. It also illustrates how talking to people who share their opinions a lot might alter how well they get along. However, since it was our first visual art project and we had the chance to learn from our mistakes, we are okay with it. Next time, we'd like to create a detailed plan for completing our project in stages. Overall, working on this project helped us develop our creative thinking skills and grasp important theories.

Role of Individual Member:

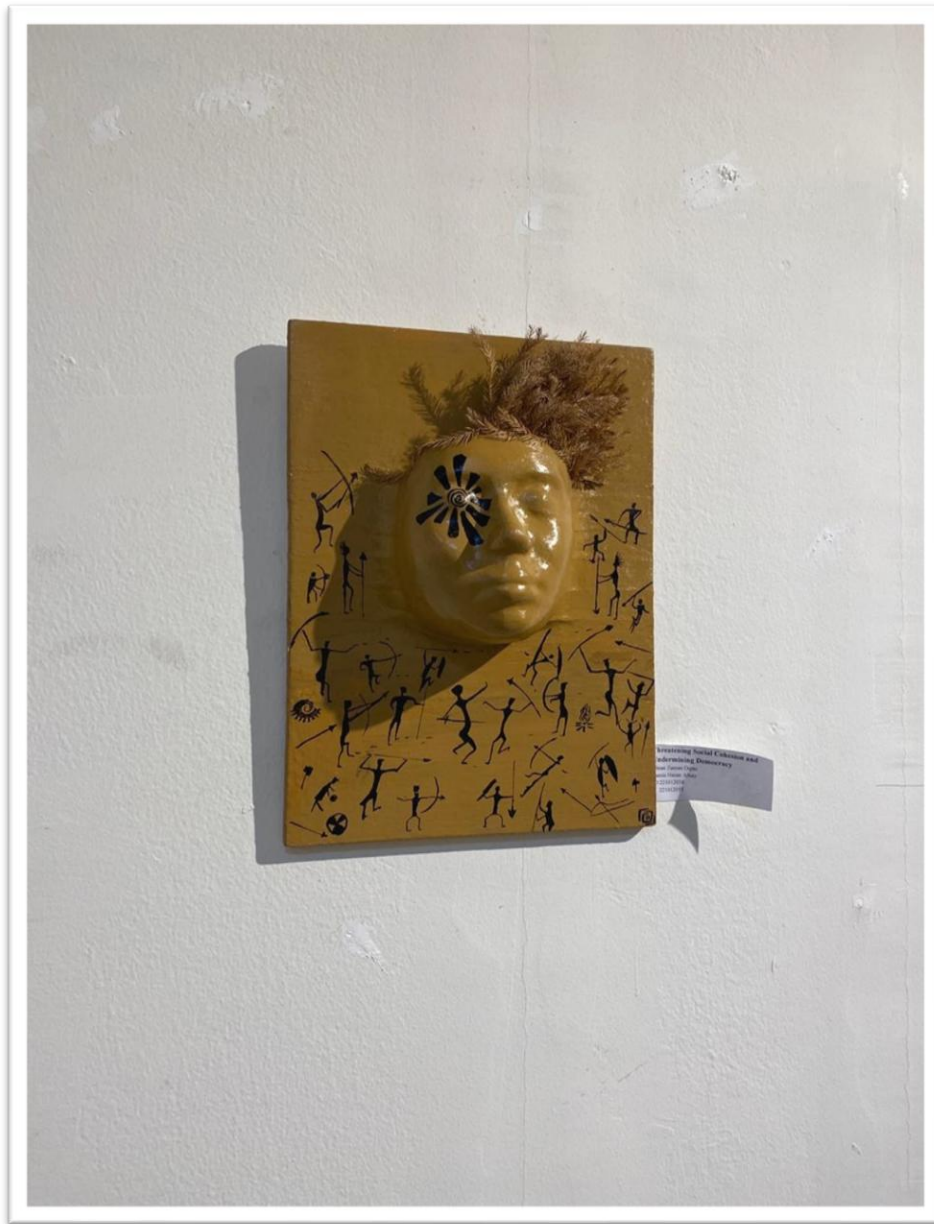
Both of us have great contributions to this mask. We worked very seriously and enthusiastically to display a wonderful mask with a strong message. We frequently discussed our ideas and incorporated them all together in the mask. We both have individual efforts as well for the mask.

Ebsan Zaman Dipto: Made the mask (first layer and second layer), polished it with sandpapers, and placed the mask on the frame according to the plan.

Samia Hasan Athay: Painted the mask And the crafting according to the plan.

We divided our work by our skills. And got a wonderful outcome.

Photographs:



Conclusion :

In summary, the CI exhibition is useful for learning new information and using it practically. We are happy that we were able to finish our project by effectively communicating the idea, even though the theme conditioning was a little challenging. We felt appreciated and that this event was successful in showcasing our ability. It was a memorable experience that we greatly enjoyed in addition to being a teaching opportunity.

Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- Learned how to express social issues through creative visual art.
- Improved my teamwork, creativity, and communication skills.
- Gained a better understanding of group polarization and its impact on society.
- Learned the importance of planning and presenting ideas effectively.